

THE SINA ANDERSON LEGACY



A Chronicle of Lineage, Faith, and Remembrance

By B.K. Anderson & Anders Taft

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A Journey Through Family and Faith

By

B.K. Anderson

“To remember is to awaken the light that never faded.”

Chapter One – The Journey to Find Sina Anderson

By B.K. Anderson

My hunt for **Sina Anderson** began with a simple thought — to find **W. H. Anderson** in Oklahoma.

There were no GPS units then, no smartphones to guide me. Just maps, a flip phone, and determination that felt older than reason. It was the year I decided to use my vacation not for rest, but for discovery — to follow the thread of my family's story into the plains.

I had already come across the accounts of **John W.** and **Thomas A. Anderson**, both of whom had gone to Oklahoma years before. Their names and stories tangled through the records, and I thought by following them, I might find W. H., and through him, the others.

As I dug deeper, I learned that **Sina Anderson** was John's mother, and **Joseph Anderson** his father. That revelation drew me further in. I

gathered everything I could — old maps, written notes, copies of stories — tucking them into a single folder so I could carry the family line with me.

The Internet was new then, slow, and stubborn, but even in those days it held enough light to guide a seeker. When all was ready, I boarded a plane for Oklahoma, rented a car, and found a room just outside **Oklahoma City**. The week began with rain — a fine drizzle that felt like memory itself — and I set out to find W. H. Anderson, who was said to rest in **Norman, Oklahoma**.

I followed paper maps, spoke to locals, and took photographs of every grave that might belong to our line. The ground was red clay, and when it rained the color deepened to rust. Even now, I can tell which grave pictures on Ancestry came from that trip — the red-tinted stones are mine. Many were in low spots where the water had pooled; the earth itself seemed to breathe through them.

When the rain became too heavy, I went to a nearby library, searching through newspapers and county archives for the Anderson name. Some graves were too deep in water to photograph that day, so I made

myself a promise: I would return later in the week when the land had dried.



Venia Wilson Anderson



William H. Anderson

Over the next few days, I journeyed through small towns — **Blanchard, Ross**, and beyond — visiting libraries, cemeteries, and any place that might hold a clue. Each stop offered a fragment of truth, a name, or a date. In Ross, I searched for Sina's sons and the **Good family**, whom she had joined after her first husband, Joseph, had died. My search took me to **East Hill Cemetery**, where I found the resting places of the Goods and the Andersons alike — threads interwoven through generations.

The land in Oklahoma is gridded by survey — perfect squares of north, east, west, and south. Easy enough to navigate with a map, yet that day, when I went to find **Sina Anderson's grave**, I felt something more than direction. She was said to rest at **Midland Cemetery**, and I left early with my maps and notes, feeling the quiet pull of purpose.

The roads narrowed as I left the main track. Dust rose from the ditches, curling around the tires in thin copper spirals.

Then I came upon a small house and a man standing outside. I stopped, stepped out, and asked if I was close to the cemetery. He smiled and said, “Yes, it’s just down the road.”

Then he looked at me and asked, “You got any bug spray?”

I told him no.

He laughed, saying, “Come here. The chiggers will carry you off if you do not have some.”

We both laughed. He sprayed me down right there by the roadside, and I thanked him. It felt like one of those strange, friendly moments that Spirit arranges — small kindnesses placed along the path like signposts of goodwill.

I drove on until I found the sign for **Midland Cemetery**. The air was still; the sound of insects hovered like a hymn.

I parked, gathered my things, and began to walk. Years of searching had taught me to start at the back of a cemetery — the older graves always lie there, the generations moving outward as time goes on. So, I made my way toward the back, eyes scanning the stones, reading names half-hidden by time.

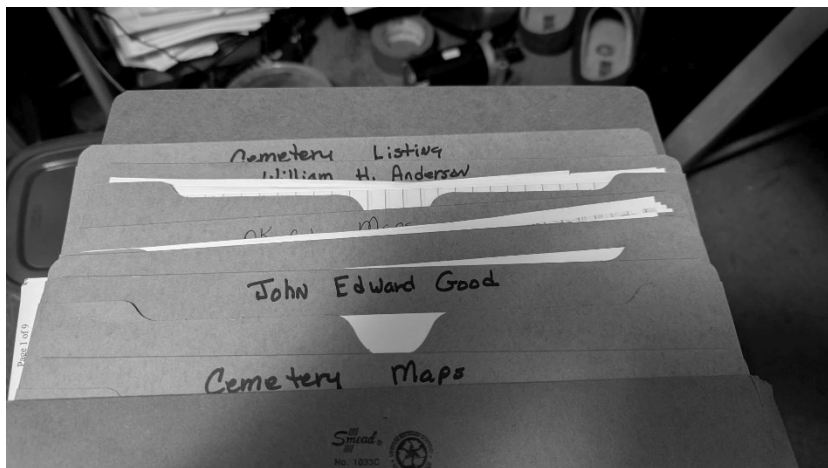
Then I saw a stone that caught the light just so. It reminded me of another grave I had seen years before, something about its shape or stance. I walked toward it, not knowing why.

When I drew close enough to read the name, my breath caught.

Sina Anderson.

I had walked straight to her. No hesitation, no searching, just a quiet pull — as if she had been waiting for me, guiding me through that field of silence and red clay.

Her spirit had led me there. I could feel it as surely as I felt the ground beneath my boots.



I took photographs — the ones now shared on family trees, each carrying that faint red hue of Oklahoma soil. Later, I visited more cemeteries and libraries in nearby towns, continuing to trace the family line. Before leaving, I went to **Oklahoma City** to pay my respects at the **Bombing Memorial** and visit the state archives.

When the journey was done, I had found everyone I set out to find — and more.

I returned my rental car, boarded the flight home, and flew back to Tennessee. I still live where the Andersons once lived generations ago. I called my mother when I returned, telling her of my trip and of the

moment I found Sina's grave. She loved hearing it — the way Spirit
had led me straight to her.

And I knew, deep down, it had been divinely guided.

So I whispered a thank-you — to God, to Sina, to the line that had
never truly broken — and carried the story home.



Alfred P. Murrah Federal Building, April 19, 1995

Oklahoma City, Oklahoma

Chapter 1 cont.— The Land They Built, The Legacy They Defended

There is a truth woven through the Anderson–Good families that has endured through fire, loss, war, and time itself:

They never gave up.

My people came from families who believed in work, education, and the power of owning land. When they settled in Tennessee, they did not inherit comfort — they created it. They cleared forests, built fields, raised homes, and brought stability to land that they had never known before. They believed that if a person worked the land, the land would work for them.

But in every generation, there are those who build...
and those who wait until the building is done.

As the region grew, others arrived after the land had been improved — and found ways to take it. Some used the law. Some used back taxes. Some used the confusion and chaos surrounding the Civil War. And

for families like mine, the hardest blow of all came when **the war destroyed the deeds, the records, and the proof of ownership** they had worked so hard for.

When **Captain John W. Anderson's home burned**, the family lost not only their shelter — they lost the documents that proved their land was rightfully theirs. In the years that followed, opportunists seized the moment. Land was taken through tax sales, technicalities, and missing papers. What my family had built through sweat and labor was taken by people who had never lifted a hand to create it.

Florence Jane Anderson Good's Testimony – The Burning of the Anderson Home (1945)

In a 1945 Tulsa newspaper interview celebrating her ninetieth birthday, Florence Jane Anderson Good shared her vivid memory of the day Union soldiers burned the Anderson family home in Manchester, Tennessee.

“That time the Yankees burned our home nearly scared me to death,” she recalled. “The cannons were roaring, and the soldiers gave my mother and me only fifteen minutes to grab things out of the house.”

Florence remembered that the family tried desperately to save their belongings, including a family clock packed with jewelry and money. “We saved only a few things,” she said. “We almost saved the clock, but the Yankees burned that, too.”

Only one item survived—a large wooden rolling pin, which she kept for the rest of her life.

Her testimony confirms the long-held family story: the home, deeds, and many early records were destroyed in the fire during the Civil War, shaping the generations that followed. Florance Anderson Good



But even then...

They did not quit.

They rebuilt.

They moved forward.

They began again with nothing but determination and faith.

This is the heart of Sina Anderson's story.

She married two families — the Andersons and the Goods — who

were strong, not because life was easy, but because life demanded resilience.

Her children and stepchildren inherited this strength.

Her grandchildren carried it west into Oklahoma.

Her descendants still carry it today.

The story of losing land is not a story of defeat.

It is a story of identity — of a family that refused to be erased.

And through the writing of this book, the legacy that others tried to take has been restored. The land may have left our hands, but the truth never left our line. What was nearly lost is now remembered. What was taken is now honored. And the